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SCLPT Studio brings boutique wellness to Athens

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📎 SCLPT Studio Interview.m4a 🎥 B-roll clip Reformer machines line the studio floor at SCLPT Studio in Athens, Ga. The boutique fitness studio, co-founded by Alexis Cason and Genna Ringler, offers both reformer Pilates and hot mat sculpt classes to members. [Photo/Grace Park]

[SCLPT Studio](#) brought something new to Athens, a boutique fitness studio combining reformer Pilates and hot mat sculpt classes under one roof. Co-founders Alexis Cason and Genna Ringler opened the studio one year ago, and it has already hit maximum capacity.

Cason earned a degree in management information systems before she started instructing at another Athens studio, where she met Ringler. Ringler holds a business and marketing degree from the University of South Carolina. She relocated to Athens for her fiancé's work after

exploring Pilates studios in Dallas. The two co-founders identified a gap: Athens had no studio combining reformer Pilates and hot mat sculpt classes under one roof, so they built one.

The idea took shape after both women independently visited the same heated mat Pilates studio in New York City within a week of each other. They had no relation to one another at this point, and the coincidence confirmed what they believed Athens needed.

"I believe we're actually one of the only studios in Georgia that offers hot mat sculpt classes and reformers in the same studio," Ringler said. "There are a lot of heated mat studios and there are a lot of reformer studios. It's easy to master one, but it's almost double the work to master two."

Both co-founders valued what Pilates offered beyond physical results.



 IMG_5630.MOV Members perform a reformer Pilates class at SCLPT Studio in Athens, Ga. The studio runs 13 to 17 classes on a typical weekday, with nearly every session filling a waitlist. [Photo/SCLPT Studio]

SCLPT surpassed both co-founders' expectations in its first year. The studio runs 13 to 17 classes on a typical weekday, and nearly every one fills a waitlist. The studio paused new memberships temporarily to protect the experience for existing clients.

"It was kind of an 'oh shit' moment," Ringler said. "We are truly at max capacity."

Both co-founders valued what Pilates offered beyond physical results.

"We want it to be a studio that you look forward to coming to, not something you're dreading or wanting to cancel," Cason said. "It's a lot easier to work a movement that you enjoy into your daily life."

Cason said that philosophy drives what separates SCLPT from a traditional gym. The studio prioritizes mental health and mindfulness over aesthetic goals. Cason and Ringler chose the name SCLPT to capture that idea, sculpting not just the body but the mind and daily routine. They designed the branding and built the website themselves, Cason said.

SCLPT serves a broad audience, according to Cason. The studio counts college students, mothers in their 30s and 40s, older women and a small but growing number of male clients among its members. The co-founders chose not to offer student discounts despite operating in a college town.

The co-founders faced challenges along the way. Scheduling conflicts and the daily pressure to lead with positivity tested them both, Ringler said. She credits a mantra Cason instilled early that everything can be figured out.



📺 IMG_5608.MOV Mats line the floor of the hot mat sculpt room at SCLPT Studio in Athens, Ga. Co-founders Alexis Cason and Genna Ringler say the heated mat class offering sets the studio apart from other fitness studios in the area. [Photo/Grace Park]

"Even on your worst days personally or business-wise, you still show up with a big smile and run a beautifully run class," Ringler said.

Cason said the studio also prioritizes a positive environment for its instructors, many of whom are college age and holding their first job. The studio works to avoid any culture of body comparison or toxic fitness messaging, she said.

Ringler said the past year has been more fulfilling than either co-founder expected.

"It's almost like we've created this very large community of like-minded people," Ringler said.

📄 Pitch Proposal